

**Forget not the voice of Thy servants, O Lord; remember that at all times we have placed our hope in Thee, O All-powerful One, and help us, we pray.**

Thursday in the Sixth Week - At the Sixth Hour Reader: The Troparion of the Prophecy, in the 1st Tone

This troparion is one of the many that are said during weekday services in Great Lent. Monday through Friday, in the 6th hour, we always have the prophecy from Isaiah, preceded by a Troparion.

This troparion is always full of compunction, and is **not** complimentary regarding human nature. But it is also filled with hope. We know God will be merciful to us. The big problem that man has is not that he sins, but that he does not turn to God for healing. These prophecies tell about our sin, and in the same breath, we turn to God for healing.

This is the distinguishing characteristic of Orthodox prayer that makes it so foreign to those who are Protestant. They're not accustomed to this kind of Prayer. They even see it in negative terms. But we see it as telling the truth and as cathartic and healing. Sometimes in this prophecy or other prayers of the church, we tell God things that, of course, He already knows. So we're not really telling God something; we are telling ourselves that thing. This is the case here, when we say "Forget not the voice of my servants, O Lord; remember that at all times we have placed our Hope in thee."

Of course, God never forgets anything, but we forget. We forget to place all of our hope in God. There's a reason why, in the Ten Commandments two of them are forbidding idolatry. In our day, we do not worship trees and rocks and animals; we worship ourselves. We consider ourselves to be the source of truth and certainly the source of competence, when neither one is true. The source of Truth is only the holy God. And the only competence is that of God. With Him we can do anything, and without Him we can do nothing. So this prophecy is really telling us to remember to put our hope in God.

After we acknowledge our weakness, we ask Him to help us, as we pray. This is the key to everything. We acknowledge our weakness, and we beg God for help, and we believe that He indeed will help us. This might seem obvious to some, but it certainly isn't obvious in the way people pray and then the way people lead their lives. And if we look at our own lives, we will see that many times we do not take this advice.

I like these troparia so much that I have created a small booklet of only these troparia and sometimes I say all of them in my morning prayers. They're wonderful and they're a good reminder of how we should approach God.

This file:

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### **Lenten Lectionary – Troparion of the Prophecy at the Sixth Hour**

**Large print:**

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**Booklet.** Print this in a duplexing printer, on both sides, in “landscape” mode, flipping the page on the short end. You will have a convenient booklet, that is very easy to read. If you have a “saddle stapler”, you can easily staple it. I have made thousands of booklets.

<http://www.orthodox.net/greatlent/lenen-lectionary-troparion-of-the-prophecy-booklet.pdf>